

Executive Office Weekly Briefing - Center for Primary Health Care (PHC)

Reporting Period: May 3 – 9, 2026

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The following table highlights the top three major happenings from the past week, emphasizing their strategic relevance to the Africa CDC mandate and continental health priorities

Office	Major Happening	Description and Key Actions	Strategic Relevance to Africa CDC
Directorate Office	1. MOU and JAP Development with Rollback Malaria (RBM) partnership	Coordination discussions advanced; preliminary framework for MOU collaboration identified; scheduled follow-up technical meetings to finalize MOU terms and implementation modalities.	Strengthens Africa CDC's continental leadership on malaria control and elimination by formalizing partnership with a key global actor. Ensures alignment of continental and global malaria agendas and mobilizes additional technical and financial resources for the malaria elimination initiative including the AMRAT established by Africa CDC.

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	2. PHC Leadership Forum	Finalized the report of the inaugural PHC Leadership Forum. Engaged the PHC Leadership Forum during the Malaria Webinar on the role of PHC Transformation in Malaria Control and Elimination in Africa.	The implementation of the PHC Leadership forum is key for Africa CDC's agenda of PHC Transformation as the engine to operationalize the AHSS, particularly its Digital Transformation, PPPR, and Local Manufacturing and APPM pillars. By creating a Member State-driven mechanism for policy translation and peer learning, Africa CDC is building the institutional architecture for coordinated transformation of PHC in this new era.
	3. Hepatitis Mission to Madagascar (Handover Ceremony)	Africa CDC officially handed over USD 200,000 worth of viral hepatitis B and C testing kits, medications, and essential supplies to the Government of Madagascar, supported by KOICA. The mission emphasized strengthening sentinel surveillance sites, improving patient management, and accelerating prevention and control efforts to support Madagascar's trajectory toward viral hepatitis elimination by 2030.	This engagement directly advances the Continental Triple Elimination Plan (HIV, Syphilis, and Hepatitis B by 2030) and aligns with the AHSS agenda. By integrating these services into routine Primary Health Care systems and strengthening laboratory capacities, Africa CDC is building resilient systems capable of preventing, detecting, and responding to health threats equitably and sustainably.
Community Health Systems	1. Preparatory Meeting for High-Level Forum on Community Health in Abuja (July 2026)	Co-convened with Nigeria FMOH, the representatives of CCM to discuss the agenda, speaker list, and strategic messaging for the continental high-level forum scheduled for July 2026 in Abuja.	This forum will serve as the primary platform for launching the Continental Acceleration Plan for Community Health and advances the AU Champion agenda for HRH and CHDP. It will also foster alignment of partners behind national acceleration plans for community health.
	2. Preparatory Meeting for High-Level Meeting on CHW Professionalization in DRC	Engage the Democratic Republic of Congo (DRC) government and technical partners to prepare for a high-level meeting focused on advancing CHW professionalization, remuneration, and integration into national health systems. This engagement supports the broader continental CHW acceleration agenda.	Advances the Continental CHW Acceleration Plan and supports the 2 Million CHW Agenda. Strengthens Africa CDC's partnership with DRC as a key player in Central Africa's health security.

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Maternal, Newborn, Child and Adolescent Health	1. AU Champion on MCH: Finalization of the roadmap (2026-2028) and preparation of the DG mission to Tanzania	Preparations for the DG's visit to Tanzania in close collaboration with Embassy, the Minister of Foreign Affairs and the Minister of Health. Strategic documents finalized (concept note, draft agenda, AU Champion Roadmap for MCH).	This mission is critical for advancing the Continental Sovereign Maternal Health and Reproductive Rights Initiative under the leadership of H.E. President Samia Suluhu Hassan. It elevates maternal and child mortality as a core health security issue and strengthens Africa CDC's bilateral partnership with Tanzania to drive continental health sovereignty discussions.
	2. PHC Digitalization: Joint briefing with 3 Countries (Ethiopia, Botswana and Senegal) on UAE Funding Opportunity	Conduct a continental briefing call with three Member States (identified as priority countries for PHC digital transformation) to present the USD 10 million catalytic investment opportunity from the United Arab Emirates for Phase I of the PHC Intelligence Ecosystem initiative. This call aimed to generate interest, clarify technical requirements, and support country-level preparation for potential participation. Conduct a comprehensive assessment of Gambia's PHC digitalization readiness, infrastructure, and capacity to inform the continental baseline survey and identify pathfinder opportunities for digital health transformation. This assessment contributes to the broader PHC Systems Transformation Framework.	Advances the PHC Intelligence Ecosystem initiative and the broader PHC Systems Transformation through Digitalization. Mobilizes resources for the continental proof-of-concept in three pilot countries (Ethiopia, Botswana, Senegal) and generates momentum for Phase II scale-up.
Infectious Diseases	1. Continental Webinar on Malaria (World Malaria Day 2026)	On May 4, 2026, Africa CDC hosted a continental webinar themed "Advancing Africa's Health Security and Sovereignty for Malaria Control and Elimination through PHC Transformation." The webinar brought together 200 participants including PHC Directors, National Malaria Control Program Directors, and key partners (UNICEF, WHO, RBM). The event outlined five critical shifts needed for malaria control, including the announcement of the Africa Malaria Response Acceleration Taskforce (AMRAT).	Malaria remains a vivid test of Africa's health security. This convening reinforced Africa CDC's leadership in coordinating a continental response plan up to 2030. By establishing AMRAT and emphasizing the integration of new tools (vaccines, genomic surveillance, digital platforms) into routine PHC systems, Africa CDC is transitioning from fragmented vertical programs to resilient, intelligence-driven health systems.

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NCDs, Injuries and Mental Health (NCDIMH)	1. Technical Validation and Launch of Continental Framework for Sickle Cell Disease and Other Rare Blood Disorders (Starting May 11, 2026, Kampala, Uganda)	Convene a high-level technical and policy meeting in Kampala to technically validate and officially launch the Continental Framework and Action Plan for Sickle Cell Disease and Other Rare Blood Disorders. This meeting brings together representatives from Member State health ministers, technical experts, patient representatives, and partners to align on a coordinated roadmap for strengthening prevention, diagnosis, treatment, surveillance, access to medicines, and comprehensive care across Africa.	Positions sickle cell disease as a priority health security issue requiring Africa CDC's coordinated continental response. Directly supports the operationalization of the AU Common Position on NCDs, Mental Health, and Injuries. Advances the Africa Health Security and Sovereignty agenda by establishing continental standards for rare blood disease management and integrating these services into resilient PHC systems.
	2. Virtual Review of SPARK-NCDs Implementation with Participating Countries (May 6, 2026)	Conduct a virtual review meeting with the four already participating countries (Rwanda, Ethiopia, Zambia, and Tanzania) to assess progress, identify challenges, and establish priorities for implementation.	Enhances alignment, shared learning, and agreement on priority actions to advance effective implementation of SPARK-NCDs in the upcoming additional countries (Lesotho, Eswatini, Namibia, Kenya, Botswana).
	3. 13th Mental Health and Advocacy Short-Course at American University of Cairo (Starting May 10, 2026)	Launch the 13th cohort of the Mental Health and Advocacy short-course at the American University of Cairo, inducting 25 mental health advocates into the Africa CDC Mental Health Leadership Programme (MHLP) network.	This course aims to train a strengthened cohort of leaders equipped to drive transformation of mental health systems in their respective countries.

2. Key Bottlenecks and Escalation Items

The following issues require immediate attention, guidance, or escalation to ensure the successful delivery of ongoing strategic initiatives.

Issue / Bottleneck	Impact / Risk Level	Required Action / SMT Guidance or Escalation
Delays in assigning budget codes for World Bank funded activities	Medium Risk: This is becoming a major concern for the implementation of our Q2 activities for the Infectious Diseases division. We have been doing follow-up with finances without success recently. The same challenge applies to STBF funds.	Escalation: Request Chief of Staff Intervention with Finances.
HR gaps for the Division of Infectious Diseases	Medium Risk: The Division of Infectious Diseases has been operating without substantive HOD for 1 year and I have been backstopping in the interim. Two positions were initially planned under WB for the division but were freeze in 2025. It is urgent that we fill the HR gaps in the Division to effectively respond to increasing requests from our MS, and to strengthen our positioning in the ongoing engagement with partners (GF, RBM, UNAIDS, etc.).	Escalation: I would like to request SMT concurrence to proceed with the recruitment of three consultants (ALD) for 11 months under WB for the role of 1. Senior Adviser, Malaria & Vector-borne Diseases - P5 2. Principal Technical Officer, HIV, TB, Viral Hepatitis & STIs - P4. 3. Senior Technical Officer, Malaria & Vector-borne Diseases - P3.
Resource Mobilization	Medium Risk: The Community Health System division is facing significant funding gaps for 2026 and 2027 due to limited allocation from WB.	Guidance: Resources Mobilization efforts will require active engagement in collaboration with ERSE to explore new streams of funding opportunities for Community Health and for Infectious Disease.